

CONNOR DE THOMASIS

Cyber Security & AI Analyst | Security & GRC | Blue Team

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PROFILE

Information Technology student at QUT majoring in Cyber Security with a second major in Artificial Intelligence, with project experience across security risk assessment, incident response planning, and the design of AI guardrails. I have pride in my work and consistently work on how I can improve and learn new skills through extra research and Homelabbing. I have translated technical findings into costed, prioritised recommendations for non-technical stakeholders, and can perform reliably under pressure with close attention to detail. I am seeking to apply academic knowledge and theory to real-world practice while completing my studies.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technology | Queensland University of Technology, Gardens Point Feb 2025 - Present

- Major in Cyber Security | Second Major in Artificial Intelligence. Expected graduation December 2027.

Secondary Graduation Certificate | Holy Spirit College, Mackay (Mount Pleasant) Graduated Nov 2024

- Awarded Year 12 Academic Excellence.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security & GRC: Security risk assessment, control effectiveness review, risk treatment & costing, business impact analysis, incident response planning, NIST SP 800-61, Privacy Act 1988 & Notifiable Data Breaches scheme, network segmentation

Detection & Infrastructure: Wazuh SIEM, MITRE ATT&CK, detection rule authoring & tuning, Windows Active Directory, pfSense, network segmentation, Proxmox VE, Kali Linux, ZFS

AI Security: LLM guardrail design, prompt injection & jailbreak defence, embedding-based classification, LLM-as-a-Judge, adversarial testing, Azure OpenAI

Programming & Data: Python, SQL, C#, Object-Oriented Programming, Git (GitHub), data analysis, AI & machine learning

Systems & Support: Linux & Windows, Command Line Interface (CLI), Microsoft Azure, structured logging & audit trails, troubleshooting

Professional: Critical thinking, adaptability, professional communication, collaboration and teamwork

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Crew Member | McDonald's, North Mackay

Mar 2022 - Jan 2025

- Trained and supported new crew members through onboarding, reinforcing food safety procedures and cleaning standards across the full back-of-house preparation process.
- Delivered front-line customer service throughout sustained high-volume periods, maintaining accuracy and composure under time pressure.
- Applied strict food safety and compliance procedures consistently across shifts in a fast-paced operating environment.

CERTIFICATIONS & LICENCES

- CompTIA Security+ Certification (In Progress).
- Valid P2 Provisional Driver's Licence (Manual).

PROJECTS

Detection Engineering Home Lab | Personal Project

2026 - Present

- Built a segmented detection engineering lab from scratch on Proxmox VE, running a Windows Active Directory domain, a Wazuh single-node SIEM and deliberately vulnerable targets, with pfSense enforcing isolation between lab and host networks.
- Emulated attack activity from a Kali VM and mapped it to MITRE ATT&CK, using the resulting telemetry to drive custom detection rules and tune them against real signal rather than synthetic samples.
- Backed the environment with ZFS mirrored storage and UPS-managed graceful shutdown to protect lab data and preserve detection history across power events.

Secure Topic-Constrained AI Chatbot with Layered Guardrails | *Queensland University of Technology* May 2026

- Built a multi-turn chatbot in Python on Azure OpenAI (GPT-4.1-mini, text-embedding-ada-002) wrapping every turn in a six-layer guardrail pipeline: token cap, normalised keyword denylist, embedding similarity against 26 jailbreak archetypes, topic-anchor similarity, and an LLM-as-a-Judge on both input and output.
- Judge verdicts deny rather than pass through, and returned generic refusals to the user while writing the triggering layer, category and similarity scores to a rotating JSON audit log, denying attackers the feedback needed to tune bypasses.
- Tested against prompt-injection, persona-escape, system-prompt-extraction and obfuscation attacks with no successful bypasses across 50+ logged decisions.

Information Security Risk Assessment - Hospitality Group | *Queensland University of Technology* Mar 2026

- Owned network infrastructure as one of six assessed assets for a simulated 10-property hotel group, identifying a flat network architecture as a Critical inherent risk (20) for organisation-wide ransomware propagation and scoring it against a semi-quantitative 5x5 likelihood and impact matrix.
- Reviewed existing segmentation, client isolation and offsite backup controls to justify a reduced residual rating, then costed and recommended endpoint detection and response and multi-factor authentication rollouts across 1,100 devices for selection into a budget-constrained year-one treatment plan.

Business Impact Analysis & Incident Response Plan | *Queensland University of Technology* May 2026

- Completed the business impact analysis for the EDR and SIEM platform, quantifying financial, operational and reputational impact, mapping cloud and network dependencies. Identified single points of failure to justify a Priority 1 recovery ranking.
- Contributed to a NIST SP 800-61 aligned incident response plan defining SEV 1-3 severity classification and response times, incident response team roles and pre-authorised actions, and OAIC notifiable data breach escalation triggers.

REFEREES

Available upon request.